

Raw Water Column Sonar Data

Data

A copy of the NCEI archive of water column sonar data is available in this AWS bucket. Each file is a binary formatted instrument file. Kongsberg/Simrad .raw files are generated by ME70, EK60, EK80 or ES60 instruments. They contain power and optionally angular position data with each beam/frequency identified by an independent channel. Kongsberg .wcd files are generated by EM302, EM122 or EM710 instruments. Additional file types from other instruments exist in this bucket. See instrument specific documentation for more information.

Bucket Structure

The name of this bucket is noaa-wcsd-pds. The data files in this bucket are primarily organized by ship name, cruise ID, then instrument name. Ship names are camel case while the cruise IDs and instrument names are uppercase. If data was collected by a stationary recorder (i.e. bottom lander), the organizational structure is by project, deployment ID, then instrument name.

Path Structures

- noaa-wcsd-pds/data/raw/ship name/cruise ID/instrument name/
- noaa-wcsd-pds/data/raw/Stationary_Recorder/project/deployment ID/instrument name/

Downloading Data

To download files using the command line, first install the [AWS CLI](#) tool. Then use the following command replacing *DESTINATION PATH* with your desired download location.

- `aws s3 cp s3://BUCKET PATH DESTINATION PATH --recursive --no-sign-request`

Examples

All data from a ship

- `aws s3 cp s3://noaa-wcsd-pds/data/raw/Atlantis DESTINATION PATH --recursive --no-sign-request`

All data from a cruise

- `aws s3 cp s3://noaa-wcsd-pds/data/raw/Atlantis/AT26-09 DESTINATION PATH --recursive --no-sign-request`

All data from a cruise and specific instrument

- `aws s3 cp s3://noaa-wcsd-pds/data/raw/Atlantis/AT26-09/EM122 DESTINATION PATH --recursive --no-sign-request`

Citation

The citation for the entire water column sonar data archive is as follows:

National Centers for Environmental Information: Water Column Sonar Data Collection. National Centers for Environmental Information, NOAA.
<http://doi.org/10.7289/V5HT2M7C>. access date.

Citations for individual datasets can be found in the readme files for each dataset, which are located with the raw data files. They are also available [here](#)

Resources

- [Map of archived data](#)
- [Information on the archive](#)
- Contact wcd.info@noaa.gov for existing data or to archive new data for public access